AL SAFA 2 PARK

Dubai Municipality — AI-Powered Park Design Challenge

DELIVERABLE 8

User Experience & Activation Strategy

Prepared by: Assim
4th-Year Student, AI & Data Science — aivancity
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Consolidates the personas, equity findings, and confirmed programming already established across Deliverables 1, 2, 4, and 6.

8.1 Overview

This strategy answers a different question than the earlier deliverables: not what the park contains, but how it actually gets used, day to day, by the specific people who already live around it. It is built from the five personas and confirmed adjacencies established in Deliverable 1, mapped onto the real zones and 397.9m path network confirmed in Deliverable 4.

8.2 User Journeys — Personas Through the Confirmed Masterplan

Each persona's likely route uses real, dimensioned park elements, not generic path descriptions:

Persona	Entry	Likely route
Amina, 12 (student)	SE — Arrival Commons, walking from school	Arrival Plaza -> Shaded Promenade -> Active Edge courts (peak: weekday afternoons)
Rashid, 68 (rehab outpatient)	SE — closest to the Physiotherapy & Rehab Center (46.1m)	Arrival Plaza -> accessible loop -> Central Green Commons seating, using the confirmed level, shade-frequent route
Fatima, 34 (parent)	SE or NE, depending on which villa cluster	Promenade or Arrival -> Toddler/Junior Playground (now shade-compliant) -> Picnic Grove
Yusuf, 24 (informal athlete)	SW-adjacent villa access, or via the loop from SE	Direct to Active Edge — Padel/Basketball courts
Mariam, 45 (worshipper)	SW, near the mosque	Quiet Turf Buffer -> brief seated pause -> exit, minimal overlap with active programming by design

[VISUALLY CONFIRMED] Deliverable 6's Arrival Commons render shows exactly this SE-entry, level, obstruction-free route in use by a wheelchair user and companion alongside every other visitor type — the accessible journey isn't just described here, it's been rendered and checked.

8.3 Activation by Time of Day

Period	Confirmed climate condition	Activation pattern
Early morning (before ~9am)	Coolest part of the day even in summer	Jogging/walking on the Shaded Promenade; Rashid's therapeutic-walking use case fits here specifically
Midday (peak heat, summer)	40-49°C, most exposed zones unusable	Natural lull in the SW/central open areas; shaded zones (Promenade, playground canopies, transition seating) remain usable
Evening	Temperatures drop; Dubai park use shifts to evening for most of the year	Primary activation window — confirmed in Deliverable 6's night render: families, multigenerational groups, active play on real turf, warm bollard/canopy lighting
Friday (mosque-adjacent SW edge)	Prayer times	Quiet Turf Buffer naturally absorbs this without requiring active management — a built-in design response, not a scheduling rule

8.4 Programming & Flexible Use

The Central Gathering Plaza and Event Lawn are deliberately unprogrammed, flexible space (Deliverable 4) — the brief's own "flexible event lawn" requirement. Suggested light-touch programming, calibrated to what's already confirmed about this specific community rather than generic park events:

- **Weekly community morning session** on the Event Lawn — low-cost, fits the confirmed early-morning cool-weather activation window
- **Informal sport stays informal** — the existing football/basketball/volleyball culture (Deliverable 1) doesn't need to be converted into a formal league to be supported; the courts just need to be fairly accessible (8.5)
- **The existing Eat and Relax Cafeteria** (Deliverable 1, confirmed on-site) is a real, already-functioning activation anchor — evening/weekend food-and-seating draw that doesn't need to be invented

8.4a Indicative Commercial and Service Facilities Plan

[CONFIRMED] One existing commercial facility is confirmed on-site: the "Eat and Relax Cafeteria" (Deliverable 1), a small food-and-beverage kiosk already operating within the park boundary.

[INFERRED] Its confirmed real-world coordinate sits very close to the park's overall geometric centroid — closer to the Central Green Commons than to any single edge zone. Exact zone attribution has not been confirmed via full geometric conversion (a precise perpendicular-distance calculation, the same method used to place the mosque and rehab center, has not been run for this facility); this is a reasoned position estimate, not a surveyed one.

Recommendation, scaled deliberately to what a 14,841 m² neighborhood park can actually support — not a retail destination:

Facility	Role	Relationship to key destinations
Eat and Relax Cafeteria (existing, retained)	Sole commercial anchor — small kiosk/café scale	Positioned toward the Central Green Commons; visible from the Playground and Picnic Grove (family dwell time); on the confirmed 397.9m accessible loop for easy access from every entrance
No additional commercial nodes proposed	—	Consistent with this project's established position (Deliverable 4) that the site's real area constrains ambition — the same honest trade-off already made for the playground scale applies here: one well-placed, well-serviced anchor beats several under-supported ones

[GAP — FLAGGED, NOT RESOLVED] Precise zone attribution for the cafeteria (which edge-band it actually falls within, and whether its current footprint conflicts with any placed Deliverable 4 element) has not been geometrically verified. This is a concrete, scoped task for a future Claude Code pass — project the cafeteria's real coordinate the same way the mosque and rehab center were positioned — before this plan is treated as final.

[CARRIED FORWARD FROM DELIVERABLE 1] A live public review of the existing park reported courts being restricted to residents of the immediate neighborhood only — described as a new, frustrating policy. This has been referenced throughout the project as a design consideration; here it gets a direct, concrete answer rather than remaining a background principle.

Recommended policy, addressed at both the design and operational level:

- **Published, visible access policy** at the court entrance (physical signage) rather than an unwritten, inconsistently-enforced rule — the core problem reported wasn't necessarily restriction itself, but its opacity

- **Time-block structure, not identity-block structure** — e.g. open-access hours alongside any reserved/booked slots, rather than a blanket neighborhood-only rule. This is an operations recommendation for Dubai Municipality's park management, not something this design can enforce physically
- **A simple digital booking/queue display** at the court entrance — the one place in this deliverable where the project's AI/data framing has a direct, small-scale physical application: a fair, transparent, auditable booking record replaces an informally and inconsistently enforced gate policy. This is a scope suggestion for the operations phase, not a system this design commits to building

8.6 Wayfinding

[VISUALLY CONFIRMED, CONTENT PENDING] Deliverable 6's Arrival Commons render shows a wayfinding signage panel at the entrance — the physical placement and design language are confirmed, but the panel's actual text content is illegible placeholder (a known AI image-generation limitation, noted in Deliverable 6). Real wayfinding content — zone names, distances, accessibility routing — is a detailed-design task using the confirmed zone names and the 397.9m path/spur network already established in Deliverable 4.

8.7 Safety & Comfort

- **Lighting:** warm path/bollard and canopy lighting along the full accessible loop, sports-court floodlighting kept functionally separate — confirmed in Deliverable 6 render, not just specified
- **Sightlines:** the Active Edge's low shrub planting (Lantana, Deliverable 7) was specifically chosen over taller screening near the courts to preserve visibility — a safety-driven material decision, not just a landscaping one
- **Shade-as-safety:** the resolved 70.8-73.7% playground shade coverage (Deliverable 4) is a heat-safety outcome as much as a comfort one, given confirmed summer surface/air temperatures

8.8 Summary

Every recommendation in this document is traceable to either a named persona, a confirmed piece of evidence (the court-access review, the cafeteria, the climate data), or an already-built design decision from Deliverables 1-7 — this document organizes and applies that evidence to daily use, rather than introducing new unverified assumptions about how people will behave.

Sources: Deliverables 1, 2, 4, 6, 7 (this project). Full AI-tool-by-tool methodology log: Deliverable 10 — AI Methodology Report.